

Terms of Reference (ToR)

1. Background

The Action for Sustainability Initiative (AFOSI) is a youth-focused, technology-backed local non-for-profit organization working to improve the quality of life for children, youth, and communities through interventions in education, climate justice, environmental sustainability, health, livelihoods, governance, and leadership. AFOSI currently implements the M.A.T.H Project (Mazingira, Afya, Tumaini na Haki Yetu), a three-year initiative funded by Sida through Barnfonden, that seeks to support the implementation of Kenya's Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) policy 2017 with a focus on APBET schools in Mukuru and Kibera.

The M.A.T.H Project operates within APBET schools in the urban informal settlement communities of Kibera and Mukuru, integrating climate change education, environmental stewardship, and child rights into school and community programming. As part of its commitment to promoting Climate Action and Education for Sustainable Development (ESD), AFOSI seeks to amplify the voices of children and young people through innovative storytelling approaches. This is through our belief that, Child-led storytelling provides a powerful platform for young people to share their experiences, solutions, and perspectives on climate change, environmental stewardship, and sustainable development.

To support this initiative, AFOSI requires the services of a qualified consultant to design, produce, and support the dissemination of climate and ESD storytelling content, including audio stories, podcasts, digital stories, and multimedia content that is engaging, ethical, and accessible to diverse audiences.

2. Purpose and Objectives of the Assignment

Overall purpose

The purpose of this assignment is to provide end-to-end consultancy support for the design, production, and dissemination of child-led climate change and ESD storytelling content that promotes awareness, learning, advocacy, and youth participation in sustainable development.

Assignment Specific Objectives

- Design a child-participatory content development process that captures authentic stories and experiences related to climate change and ESD from children in Kibera and Mukuru APBET Schools.
- Produce high-quality audio/podcast episodes and related digital storytelling assets that are engaging, accessible, and ESD-aligned.
- Ensure all production processes adhere to child safeguarding, ethical standards, and informed consent requirements.
- Provide initial dissemination support to ensure content reaches target audiences across relevant digital and social media platforms.
- Deliver a sustainable content workflow including tools, licenses, and documented processes for continued production beyond the consultancy period.
- Build AFOSI's staff capacity to utilize storytelling as a tool for climate action and ESD advocacy.

3. Scope of the Assignment

Included in the Assignment

- Develop a climate/ESD storytelling strategy and editorial framework, including story selection criteria, narrative structures, and audience targeting co-created with staff through collaborative workshops. Design and facilitate child and youth story ideation and recording sessions, including development and implementation of safeguarding protocols and informed consent processes for child participants.
- Provide audio recording equipment, lead podcast production editing, and quality assurance of all produced content. Procure and maintain monthly licensing and renewal of audio editing and basic design tools required for production.
- Develop branded graphic design templates and digital assets for content dissemination across social media and podcast channels.
- Design and deliver a structured capacity building programme that equips staff to independently sustain all areas of this assignment beyond the consultancy period. This includes hands-on coaching in podcast production and editing, training in child and youth facilitation and safeguarding compliance, orientation on graphic design templates and digital asset creation, and practical training in platform management, dissemination workflows, content scheduling, and performance monitoring. All tools, licenses, and platforms procured under this assignment will be transitioned to organisational ownership with accompanying documentation and user guidance.

Not Included in the Assignment

- Large-scale commercial advertising or paid promotional campaigns.

- School curriculum development or ESD training delivery (covered under a separate project component).
- Procurement of major broadcast or studio infrastructure.

Expected work effort (e.g., number of days/hours if known)

The consultancy is structured as a single package with an initial production phase. The total duration and effort shall be agreed upon at contracting. Indicative effort is distributed for 60 days for production phase and staff capacity building.

4. Assignment Content and Activities

Specify the main work components.

Phase 1 – Inception and Planning

- Hold an inception meeting with AFOSI team.
- Review of project documents, ESD objectives, and existing content strategies.
- Co-design diverse storytelling framework and content themes with AFOSI MATHproject staff.
- Development of safeguarding and consent protocols in line with AFOSI's Child Safeguarding Policy and Barnfonden requirements.
- Preparation of recording session plans and facilitation guides.

Phase 2 - Facilitation and Recording

- Facilitation of participatory story development workshops with children and youth in Kibera and/or Mukuru.
- Develop scripts, storyboards, and production plans.
- Recording of audio/podcast episodes with child participants, ensuring a safe, child-friendly environment.
- Capture of supporting digital content (e.g., images, written stories) for multi-platform use, subject to appropriate consent.

Phase 3 - Production and Editorial

- Audio editing, sound design, and production of podcast episodes.
- Graphic design and preparation of digital assets (cover art, episode visuals, social media cards).
- Record and edit interviews, stories, and podcast episodes.
- Produce and mix audio and digital storytelling products.
- Editorial review, fact-checking, and alignment of content with ESD messaging frameworks.

- Quality assurance review prior to publication.

Phase 4 - Dissemination and Ongoing Support

- Publishing of content to agreed platforms (podcast directories, AFOSI social media channels).
- Monthly management of digital publishing and scheduling tools.
- Monthly boosted online visibility to target audiences (schools, youth networks, ESD stakeholders) - non-commercial intent.
- Working with the project Manager and Finance, ensure active subscriptions, maintenance and renewal of all relevant audio editing and design software licenses.

Reporting

- Submit monthly progress reports.
- Provide final consultancy report with lessons learned and recommendations

5. Deliverables

Deliverable	Format	Description
Inception Report	PDF / Word	Methodology, work plan, and dissemination strategy
Content strategy and storytelling Framework	PDF / Word	Story development guidelines and safeguarding procedures
Minimum 10 produced podcast episodes (child-led climate/ESD stories)	MP3 / Audio files	Audio stories, podcasts, digital stories, and related materials
Consent Documentation	PDF / Word	Records and safeguarding compliance documentation
Digital asset package (cover art, episode visuals, social media cards)	JPEG / PNG / PDF	With each episode
Dissemination Plan	PDF / Word	Audience targeting and content distribution plan
Final Consultancy Report	PDF / Word	Summary of outputs, outcomes, lessons learned and recommendations

All deliverables to be submitted in English. Accessibility requirements (e.g., transcripts, captions) should be discussed at inception.

Accessibility Requirements

- Inclusive and child-friendly content.
- Accessible audio formats.

- Clear and culturally appropriate language.

6. Timeline

Milestone	Activity	Indicative Date
Contract signing	Finalization and signing of contract	Week 1
Inception meeting	Kickoff with AFOSI team	Week 1
Strategy & safeguarding docs	Submission of D1 and D2	Week 2
Recording sessions	Facilitation and recording with children	Weeks 3–5
Episode production	Post-production and editorial review	Weeks 5–7
First content published	Publication of first episode/assets	Week 8
Final report	Consultancy completion report	End of contract

7. Organization and Responsibility

Client / Purchaser

Action for Sustainability Initiative (AFOSI), Nairobi, Kenya Our organisation's contact person

AFOSI Contact Person

Name: Esther Mwikali Kiilu

Title: Project Manager

Email: ekiilu@afosi.org

Phone: 0717662503

Consultant's Responsibility

- Day-to-day management of all production activities
- Coordination of recording sessions in liaison with AFOSI's field and programme teams.
- Ensuring safeguarding and consent protocols are followed throughout.

- Timely delivery of all agreed deliverables.

Collaboration and Meetings

- Bi-weekly check-in meetings with the AFOSI programme team during the production phase.
- Monthly review meetings during the ongoing support phase.
- Ad-hoc communications via email and agreed messaging channels.

8. Consultant Requirements

Specify mandatory and meriting requirements.

8.1 Mandatory Selection Criteria

The consultant/firm must demonstrate:

- A degree or equivalent qualification in communications, journalism, media production, education, environmental studies, or a related field.
- At least five (5) years of experience in large scale multimedia production, storytelling, or digital communications.
- Proven experience producing podcasts, audio stories, or digital storytelling products.
- Demonstrated experience working with children and youth.
- Knowledge of climate change, sustainability, and/or Education for Sustainable Development.
- Experience implementing safeguarding and consent procedures.
- Samples of work for previous similar works done with references.

MANDATORY REQUIREMENTS

- Compliance with ILO core conventions (applies to supplier and subcontractors): Freedom of association (ILO 87, 98), no forced labour (ILO 29, 105), no child labour (ILO 138, 182), non-discrimination (ILO 100, 111), safe and healthy working environment (ILO 155, 187).
- Comply with AFOSI and Barnfonden policies: Code of Conduct, Child Safeguarding Policy, Whistleblowing Policy, Prevention of Sexual Exploitation, Abuse and Harassment (PSEAH) Policy.

8.2 Additional Selection Criteria

Economic and Financial Capacity

- Demonstrated financial stability sufficient to execute the assignment (e.g., minimum annual turnover at least twice the estimated contract value).

- Adequate professional liability or indemnity insurance appropriate to the assignment risks.

Technical and Professional Capacity

- Portfolio of at least two relevant prior assignments (audio/podcast production, digital storytelling for development, or media for social change).
- Evidence of safeguarding training and/or child protection protocols in past media work.
- Access to appropriate audio recording equipment and editing software.

Meriting Requirements (also used as evaluation criteria)

- Experience producing content with or for children and young people.
- Knowledge of climate change, environmental sustainability, or ESD in a Kenyan or East African context.
- Experience with digital platform management (podcast directories, social media scheduling tools).
- Demonstrated capacity to work within NGO / civil society environments and meet donor reporting standards.

9. Method and Working Approach

The consultant is expected to propose a clear methodology that demonstrates:

- A participatory, child-centred approach to story ideation and content development that upholds children's right to be heard and to express themselves freely.
- A norm-critical and child rights-based perspective, with particular attention to gender, disability inclusion, and the specific vulnerabilities of children in informal settlements.
- Environmental and ESD sensitivity in framing stories, ensuring content contributes to children's understanding of and agency in climate action.
- Ethical rigour: robust safeguarding, consent, data protection, and responsible representation of child voices and images.
- Technical quality: use of appropriate tools and workflows to ensure professional-grade audio and digital outputs

10. Confidentiality and Intellectual Property Rights

- All content, recordings, scripts, and materials produced under this assignment are the property of AFOSI, unless otherwise agreed in writing.
- The consultant shall maintain strict confidentiality regarding all project information, beneficiary data, and organizational materials accessed during the assignment.

- Personal data of child participants shall be handled in compliance with applicable Kenyan data protection law and GDPR principles, given the Sida/Barnfonden funding relationship.
- No materials featuring children shall be used, shared, or published without valid informed consent from parents/guardians and assent from the children themselves.
- All raw recordings and data shall be securely deleted or returned to AFOSI upon contract completion.)

11. Compensation and Pricing

Bidders are required to submit a comprehensive and itemized price proposal covering:

Cost Item	Frequency	Proposed Amount (KES)
Consultancy Package - Design, production & dissemination support (content development, child participation facilitation, recording, post-production, safeguarding, editorial, equipment & initial dissemination)	One-off (lump sum)	
Digital platform management tools (scheduling, publishing, monitoring)	Monthly subscription	
Online visibility & boosted reach support (non-commercial)	Monthly	
Licensing & renewal of audio editing and basic design tools	Monthly	
TOTAL		

Prices must be inclusive of all taxes (VAT where applicable). Payment terms and invoicing schedule to be agreed at contracting.

12. Evaluation of Bids

Contract is awarded based on either:

- Best balance between price and quality
- Best price/cost (minimum requirements must be met)

13. Self-Declaration on Exclusion Grounds

Bidders must self-declare that they are not subject to any of the following exclusion grounds:

- Bankruptcy, insolvency, or similar proceedings.
- Serious professional misconduct.

- Failure to fulfil tax or social contribution obligations.
- Fraud, corruption, organised crime, money laundering, terrorist financing, child labour, or human trafficking.
- Significant deficiencies in performance under previous contracts funded by AFOSI, Barnfonden, Sida, or other institutional donors.
- Presence on EU sanctions lists or the World Bank debarred list. Presence on EU sanctions lists or World Bank debarred list

14. Bid Contents

A complete bid submission must include:

- Organisation or individual profile (maximum 3 pages).
- Portfolio: minimum two relevant work samples (links or attachments).
- CVs of key personnel who will execute the assignment.
- Technical proposal: understanding of the assignment, proposed methodology, work plan, and team structure.
- Itemised financial proposal (aligned to the pricing table in Section 11).
- Signed self-declaration on exclusion grounds (Section 13).
- Confirmation that the bidder has read, understood, and agrees to comply with: AFOSI's Child Safeguarding Policy; Barnfonden's Code of Conduct and PSEAH Policy; ILO core conventions as referenced in Section 8.1.
- Proof of relevant insurance (professional indemnity or equivalent).
- Two professional references (name, organisation, contact details, nature of prior engagement).

15. Bid Submission

Submission Deadline	
Format	PDF via email (maximum 10MB)
Submit to	
Subject Line	"TOR Application – ESD Storytelling Consultancy – [Bidder Name]"
Deadline for Questions	
Questions to	

16. Evaluation of Bids

Bids will be evaluated based on:

- Understanding of the assignment.
- Relevant experience and qualifications.
- Quality and feasibility of the proposed methodology.
- Experience with child-led storytelling and safeguarding.
- Financial competitiveness/Price
- Quality of previous work samples and references.